

Sushila Phool Bhandar

सुशीला फूल भण्डार · Website project summary

Business: Gajra and flower stall, Shop No. 4, Gate No. 2, Kalkaji Mandir Road, New Delhi 110019

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Live site: <https://hitanshbhutani.github.io/sushila-phool-bhandar/>

Source code: <https://github.com/hitanshbhutani/sushila-phool-bhandar>

1. About the business

Sushila Phool Bhandar is a flower stall on the road that goes up to Kalkaji Mandir in South Delhi. It is not a shop with a shutter, it is an allotted roadside stall with a tin roof and a blue tarpaulin, sitting between the prasad and chunri sellers.

It was started in 1987 by Ram Kishan Prasad, who sold loose marigold out of a cane basket near the temple gate. He died in 1994 and his wife **Sushila Devi** carried the work on. Today she runs it with her son **Rakesh Kumar**, who does the buying at Ghazipur Phool Mandi and handles function orders, and his wife **Pooja**, who does the threading and the veni work.

Their main product is **mogra gajra** - jasmine buds hand-threaded on cotton thread, worn in the hair. They also sell bela and chameli gajra, veni, marigold and rose garlands, loose flowers for pooja, and they take decoration orders for weddings, sagai, mundan and griha pravesha. They make between 250 and 400 gajra on a normal day and close to a thousand on Shivratri or the first day of Navratri.

Type of business	Retail flower stall, family run
Running since	1987 (three generations)
People	Three, all family
Speciality	Mogra gajra, threaded on site every morning
Online presence before this	None at all - no website, no Instagram, no Google listing
Permission	Given verbally by Rakesh Kumar and Sushila Devi

2. Interview notes

Spoken to Rakesh Kumar at the stall, with Sushila Devi joining in the second half. Conversation was in Hindi, notes translated.

Q. Why do you want a website at all?

Rakesh said the phone rings all day with people asking rates, and he is at the mandi from four in the morning so he cannot always pick up. If the rate list is somewhere he can send a link to, that is half his problem gone.

Q. What work actually makes you the most money?

Not the gajra. It is the wedding and function decoration - mandap, car decoration, varmala, gate toran. But people walking past only see a gajra stall and never think to ask. He said this twice, so I made it a whole section on the home page.

Q. Do you want people to order and pay online?

No. Clear no. Flowers change rate every day and he has to see how big the venue is before quoting. He wants the enquiry to land on **WhatsApp**, where he already does all his business, and then he will call the person.

Q. Is there any problem with people finding you?

Yes. "Near Kalkaji Mandir" is not an address and new customers phone from the metro station asking which side to walk. He wanted directions written properly.

Q. Do you have a logo, or any branding?

No logo. The board on the stall is hand-painted, just the name in Hindi and English. Sushila Devi said not to make anything fancy.

Q. Anything you definitely do not want?

Sushila Devi did not want photos of the family put up, and did not want the site to look "like a big company". Rakesh did not want prices shown as fixed, because the mandi rate moves.

"Rate to roz badalta hai. Likh dena ki phone karke pooch lein."

(The rate changes every day. Write that they should call and ask.) - Rakesh Kumar

3. Website goals

1. **Publish the rate list** so it can be sent as a link instead of read out on the phone, with a clear line saying rates move with the mandi.
2. **Show that they do function and wedding work**, which is the higher value work nobody knows about.
3. **Get enquiries onto WhatsApp** in a usable form - name, phone, date, what is needed - instead of a half-finished phone call.
4. **Help people physically find the stall** with real walking directions from the metro.
5. **Look trustworthy and old**, because being there since 1987 is genuinely their strongest selling point.

Explicit non-goals, from the interview: no online payment, no cart, no fixed prices, no photos of the family, no login.

4. Target audience

Who	What they came for	What the site must do for them
Local regulars Kalkaji, Govindpuri, CR Park	A gajra on the way home, pooja flowers on Tuesday	Show timings and today's open/closed status. Mostly on a phone, quickly.
Families with a function shaadi, sagai, mundan, griha praves	Decoration for an event, comparing two or three vendors	Show the function work, starting rates, notice period, and a way to enquire that does not need a phone call.
Temple visitors and new customers	Flowers for the mandir, or looking for "the gajra shop"	Directions from the metro, and enough description to recognise the stall.
Shops and offices nearby	A daily flower supply arrangement	Say that this service exists, with a monthly starting rate.

Almost all of them will be on a phone, on mobile data. That decided a lot - no big images, no framework, four small pages.

5. Features

Must have

Feature	Why
Full rate list in a table	Goal 1. Split into gajra, mala, and pooja so it can be scanned.
Search box on the rate list	The list is 23 rows. Typing "mala" beats scrolling on a phone.
Function and decoration section	Goal 2, the money work.
Order enquiry form to WhatsApp	Goal 3. Validates name, 10 digit mobile and details, then opens WhatsApp with the message already written.

Address, timings and walking directions	Goal 4.
Open / closed indicator	Works out from the current time whether the stall is open. Tuesday has different hours.
Click to call and click to WhatsApp	Most visits are on a phone.
Mobile layout	Tested down to 320px wide.

Deliberately left out

- **Cart and online payment** - the owner said no, and the rate is not fixed.
- **Contact form that sends email** - Rakesh does not use email. It would have gone unread. WhatsApp instead, which also means the site needs no server.
- **Photo gallery** - I have no good photographs yet and did not want to use stock images of flowers that are not theirs. Hand-drawn SVG for now.
- **A logo** - the shop does not have one and the brief said not to invent one.

6. Design decisions

Colours

Taken off the stall itself rather than from a palette generator, so the site looks like the place it belongs to.



#2f5134
Thread green - the cotton the gajra is strung on. Header, footer, headings.



#e0982a
Genda (marigold). Accent bar, dividers, focus outlines.



#9e2a5c
The pink of the plastic bags they hand flowers out in. Prices, buttons, links.



#faf6ec
Newspaper, which is what flowers get wrapped in. Page background.



#ffffdf
Mogra petal white. Cards and form panels.

Green on cream also stays readable in bright sun, which matters because people will open this standing on the road outside the stall.

Type

Yatra One

Headings and the shop name. It has the thick, slightly uneven look of a hand-painted Delhi signboard, which is exactly what the stall's real board looks like. Only one weight exists, so it is used sparingly.

Mukta

Body text. Chosen because it carries proper Devanagari as well as Latin, so सुशीला फूल भण्डार sits in the same family as the English rather than falling back to a system font.

Kalam

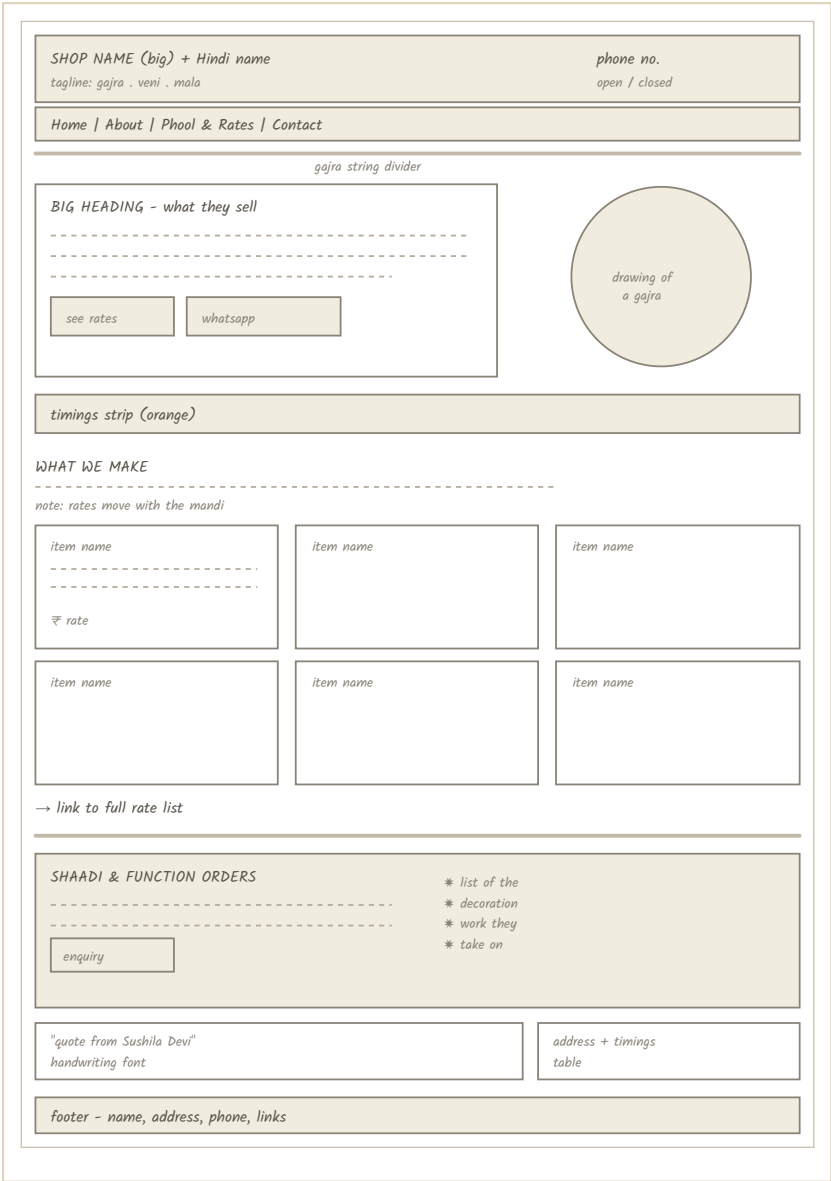
Only for the two quotes from Sushila Devi and the caption under the drawing. It is a handwriting face and would be unreadable in bulk.

Layout and branding

- Single column, one clear thing at a time, maximum width 1020px. Content-first because most of what the site has to give is text - rates, timings, directions.
- A repeating **gajra string** drawn in SVG is used as the divider between sections instead of a plain rule. It is the one decorative idea in the whole design and it comes straight from the product.
- Square corners and flat colour, no shadows or gradients. A roadside stall should not look like a startup.
- **No logo was made.** The shop does not have one, and the brief said not to invent one. The name is set in Yatra One and that acts as the wordmark.
- Hindi appears next to English in the header and in one strip, the way a real shop board is painted in both.

7. Wireframes

Sketched before writing any code, to fix what goes on the home page and in what order.



Home page, desktop.



Home page, phone. Everything stacks, the drawing moves above the heading, and buttons go full width.

The other three pages

ABOUT US

quick facts

how a gajra is made

timeline of the years

quote from aunty

PHOOL & RATES

search box

item / rate

function rates table

FAQ - click to open

CONTACT

enquiry form

send

address

timings

how to reach

map link

About Us, Phool & Rates, and Contact.

8. Tools used

Tool	Used for	Why this and not something else
HTML5	Four static pages	The site is four pages of mostly text. Semantic HTML plus a native <code><details></code> element handled the FAQ with no JavaScript at all.
CSS3 (Grid + Flexbox)	All layout and styling, one file	I started to add Bootstrap and then removed it. It was 200KB to get a grid I could write in six lines, and every Bootstrap site looks like every other Bootstrap site - the opposite of what this shop needed.
Vanilla JavaScript	Open/closed status, rate search, form validation and the WhatsApp message	About 120 lines in one file. No library was needed and jQuery would have been heavier than everything else on the page put together.
Inline SVG	The gajra drawing, the flower divider, the favicon	No photographs exist yet and I did not want stock images of somebody else's flowers. SVG stays sharp, weighs almost nothing, and is coloured from the same palette.
Google Fonts	Yatra One, Mukta, Kalam	Mukta was the deciding factor because it covers Devanagari properly.
Git + GitHub Pages	Version control and free hosting	Free, no server to maintain, and the site is fully static so it fits exactly. This is also why the enquiry form goes to WhatsApp rather than to a backend.

Where AI was used, and where it was not

I used AI to speed up the boring parts - the first draft of the CSS reset and the media queries, and to check my phone number validation regex. What I did not hand over was the content or the design decisions. The rates, the timings, the notice period for wedding orders and everything on the About page came from the interview and from watching them work. The colours were picked off the stall. The one thing AI kept pushing me towards was a generic sans-serif in blue and grey with rounded cards and a hero image, which would have looked like every other template and nothing like a flower stall outside a temple.

9. Testing

- Checked on Chrome desktop and on a phone at 375px wide. Also squeezed to 320px, which is where the nav bar was breaking onto two lines until I tightened the padding.
- All internal links between the four pages checked both ways.
- Form tested with: nothing filled in, a phone number starting with 1, a two letter message, and a correct entry. It correctly refuses the first three, marks the exact field that is wrong in red, and puts the cursor on it.
- Phone numbers typed as +91 98111 22333 or 098111 22333 both get cleaned to ten digits before the WhatsApp link is built.
- Rate search tested with a term that matches nothing, which shows the "nothing matched" message with the phone number in it.

10. What I would do next

- Photographs. This is the biggest gap - the drawings are a stand-in and real photos of the stall at six in the morning would do more than anything else on this list.
- A Hindi version of the whole site, not just the header. Half their customers would read it faster.
- Get them onto Google Business so the stall shows up on Maps, which is probably worth more to them than this website is.
- A short seasonal note on the home page they could ask me to change - "bela is in, mogra rate is up this week".

11. Submission links

Live website	https://hitanshbhutani.github.io/sushila-phool-bhandar/
Source code	https://github.com/hitanshbhutani/sushila-phool-bhandar
This document	docs/summary.pdf in the same repository

Built by Hitansh Bhutani with the permission of Sushila Devi and Rakesh Kumar of Sushila Phool Bhandar. The phone number shown on the live site is a placeholder, since the repository is public.